

IPCop can be installed on a flash drive instead of a standard hard disk. (IDE or SATA flash drives are available with a 256 MB capacity at a very reasonable price.) There are distinct advantages in flash-based installation such as: less power requirement, no moving parts compared with the hard disk, flash-based systems can better fit in Mini ITX cabinets compared to hard-disk-based systems, and so on.

But these advantages have to be enjoyed with caution: flash drives have limited write cycles—which means, if this limit is exceeded, the drive may become unreliable or stop functioning. IPCop continuously generates a lot of logs to be stored, which may damage the flash drive in a short time. To prevent this, flash-based IPCop installations collect all log entries on a RAM-disk, and write them to the flash at periodic intervals—typically, once a day.

IPCop 1.4.21 supported flash-based installation only via additional installation steps—beginning with a hard disk installation, creation of an image, followed by copying it on the flash drive. It also lacked support for SATA flash drives. In IPCop 2.0.x, hard disk as well as flash-based installations are readily supported by the default installer.

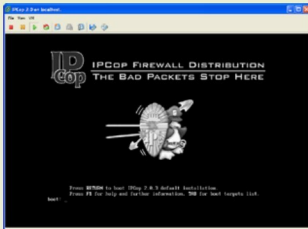


Figure 1: Installation Welcome screen

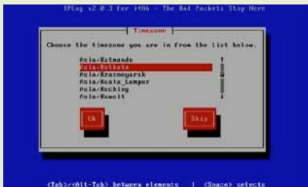


Figure 2: Timezone selection



Figure 3: Be warned!! This will format the disk



Figure 4: Select installation target - Hard disk or Flash



Figure 5: Choose the Internet connection type



Figure 6: Assign ethernet card, note LED Blink button!!